

# James Praise

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product marketing and go-to-market operator with seven-plus years building positioning, launch, and enablement systems at fintech and B2B software companies across Africa, North America, and Europe. I have been the first or early marketing hire more than once, including at two fintechs with a working sales motion and no written story. Before running marketing I carried a quota, moving from Sales Manager to Head of Growth to Chief Revenue Officer at Cecure Intelligence Limited, so I build battlecards and enablement for how a live call actually goes. Work has contributed to \$10M+ in qualified pipeline and 15+ product launches. More at <https://jamespraise.xyz/work/flex/>.

### Selected Achievements:

- Built the **growth and product marketing function from zero at Bujeti (YC W23)**, a spend and expense management platform sold to finance teams, competing in the same category as Ramp and Brex. **1,331 marketing-qualified leads in 6 months** and **500% growth in new business customers** in a single quarter.
  - **Repositioned Reform** from a feature into a category-defining conversion product, then built the launch operating system to sustain it. **34% lift in trial activation**, 19% more decision-stage leads from competitor comparison pages, **26% lift in new feature adoption** within 90 days.
  - Ran **product marketing at Bento Africa**, a payroll and human resources fintech operating across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, and Rwanda, partnering directly with Product on in-product messaging. **50% increase in sales-qualified leads** and **25% increase in sales conversions**.
  - Carried revenue as **Chief Revenue Officer at Cecure Intelligence Limited**, after starting as Sales Manager. Ran go-to-market across five African markets: 1,646 MQLs, 406 SQLs, 629 demos booked, \$3.4M in open deal value.
  - Codified my product marketing and go-to-market methods into **31 marketing agent skills published publicly** on GitHub, including the competitive intelligence and battlecard framework other operators install and run.
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## KEY SKILLS

**Product Marketing:** Positioning & Messaging Frameworks, Competitive Intelligence & Battlecards, Win/Loss Analysis, Multi-Product Narrative & Portfolio Positioning, ICP & Persona Definition, Launch Strategy & Readiness, Sales Enablement & Objection Handling, Customer Proof & Case Study Development.

**Go-to-Market:** Zero-to-One Marketing Function Build, Product-to-Marketing Operating Cadence, Lifecycle & Campaign Messaging Input, Demand Generation, Pricing & Packaging Input, Multi-Market Expansion.

**Domain:** B2B FinTech (spend management, payroll, payments, banking), Regulated & Complex Products, B2B SaaS, Product-Led Growth.

**Tools:** HubSpot, Salesforce, Apollo, Clay, GA4, Looker Studio, Gong-style call-recording review, Claude Code, n8n, Webflow, Ahrefs, Brevo.

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present

*Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media, Academy, Community)*

- Built an execution-first marketing ecosystem from zero: newsletter, community, academy, and consulting, run as a real revenue business with live paid acquisition.
- Published **31 marketing agent skills** on GitHub ([github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills](https://github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills)), including the competitive intelligence, positioning, and sales enablement frameworks I use in client work.
- Grew the newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**, publishing original applied playbooks weekly.
- Built **MIA GTM**, a go-to-market service for technology companies and agencies, with positioning developed per niche rather than templated across five distinct buyer segments.

### Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026

*Reform (SaaS, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy 2023)*

- **Repositioned the product** from a form builder into a conversion-focused category leader, rewriting the narrative across website, onboarding, and sales collateral. **34% lift in trial activation.**
- Built **competitor comparison pages** and the supporting objection handling, generating **19% more decision-stage leads.**
- Built the **Feature Launch Plan Framework**, a repeatable launch operating system spanning web, email, in-app, and partner channels, with a defined readiness bar before anything shipped externally. **26% lift in new feature adoption in 90 days.**

### GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026

*FunnelEnvy (B2B, Revenue Funnel Optimization Service Provider)*

- Built a **Target Account Strategy and account-based marketing playbook** with segment-specific messaging and enablement. **31% lift in enterprise meeting bookings, 27% increase in outbound reply rates.**
- Built content and enablement infrastructure producing 10+ multi-channel outputs per asset for marketing and sales. **40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.**

- Led the FunnelEnvy rebrand and launched GrowthNode.ai as a new brand from zero: positioning, narrative, website, deployment.

### **Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti (YC W23) | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024**

*Bujeti (FinTech SaaS, Spend & Expense Management Platform)*

- **First marketing hire.** Built the acquisition, product marketing, and lifecycle function from zero in a competitive fintech category, with no marketing leader above me.
- Owned positioning and messaging for a spend and expense management product sold to finance teams, the same buyer and category Ramp and Brex compete for.
- **1,331 MQLs in 6 months. 500% increase in new B2B customers in Q1 2024.** 20% lift in landing page conversion, 18% lift in product conversion, 10% reduction in churn.

### **Growth & Product Marketing Manager | Bento Africa | Jan 2022 – Dec 2022**

*Bento (FinTech / HR Tech SaaS, Payroll & HRM Platform)*

- Owned product marketing for a payroll and human resources platform operating across **Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, and Rwanda**, adapting positioning per market.
- Partnered **directly with Product** on in-product messaging, microcopy, and activation, with no dotted-line product manager relationship.
- Designed the lead scoring model and lifecycle nurture programs. **50% increase in SQL volume, 25% increase in sales conversions.**

### **Chief Revenue Officer (from Sales Manager) | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023**

*CIL (B2B, Technology Solutions & Technical Training Provider)*

- Progressed from **Sales Manager** to Partnerships Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to **Chief Revenue Officer**, carrying a quota before owning the function.
- Unified revenue operations across multiple business units and launched CIL Academy across **five African markets**.
- **1,646 MQLs, 406 SQLs, 629 demos booked, \$326K sales velocity, \$3.4M open deal value.** 10,000+ users onboarded in the Academy's first cohort.

### **GTM Consultant | Hank Robotics | Aug 2025 – Nov 2025**

- Built positioning, messaging, and ICP playbooks from scratch for a company with no existing marketing function. **+1,900% MQL growth in 3 months.**

### **Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022**

*B2B, SaaS, FinTech, ecommerce, agencies*

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## SELECTED PUBLIC WORK

- **Marketing Agent Skills** — 31 skills published publicly, including competitive intelligence, product positioning, and sales enablement frameworks. [github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills](https://github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills)
  - **Marketing In Action** — Execution-first marketing newsletter and ecosystem, 5,000+ subscribers. [marketinginaction.xyz](https://marketinginaction.xyz)
  - **Case studies** — Bujeti, Bento Africa, Reform, CIL, FunnelEnvy and others. [jamespraise.xyz/work](https://jamespraise.xyz/work)
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## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026), CGPA 4.92/5.0
  - **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018), CGPA 4.46/5.0
  - **Product Marketing Certification**, plus 70+ certifications across growth, analytics, product, AI, sales, and marketing operations
  - **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
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